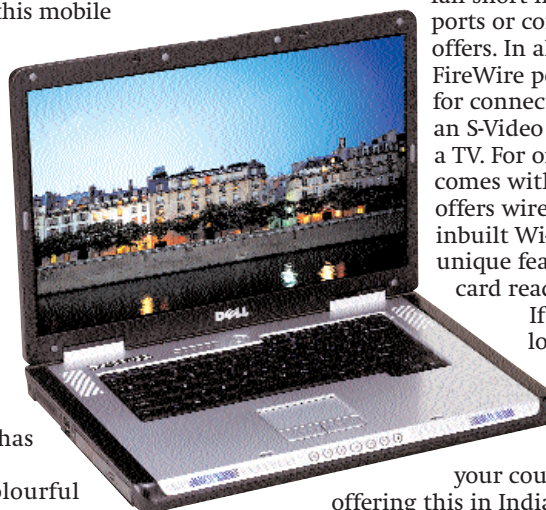


DELL XPS GEN 2

The XPS Gen 2 from Dell is an exquisite gaming machine loaded to the gills with features that stand to redefine gaming on a mobile platform. Based on Intel's Centrino platform, it incorporates the latest avatar of this mobile platform, known as Sonoma.

Armed with a top-of-the-line Pentium M 2.13 GHz processor with a 533 MHz front side bus and 2 MB of cache memory, it has enough juice to rock your games. 512 megs of DDR 2 memory comes as standard which can be further upgraded to 2 GB for blistering-fast game loading speeds. To make gaming characters come alive, the Gen 2 incorporates nVidia's best-in-class GeForce Go 6800 Ultra PCI-Express graphics core.

All the action can be viewed on the crystal clear 17-inch display that Dell is renowned for. Encased in silver-and-grey plastic, this second-generation XPS laptop has much better visual appeal. To liven up the gaming experience, Dell has introduced colourful lights on the top lid, air vents and speaker vents. You can assign up to sixteen different colours to these lights!



It's not all looks, though. Ergonomics, too, is spot on; the keyboard is sufficiently large, with a good amount of real estate on which to rest your palms.

The XPS Gen 2, being a desktop replacement, does not fall short in offering the numerous ports or connectors that a desktop PC offers. In all, there are six USB ports, a FireWire port, DVI and VGA connectors for connecting an external display, and an S-Video connector for hooking it to a TV. For online gaming, the XPS comes with an Ethernet port and offers wireless connectivity via the inbuilt Wi-Fi 802.11b/g adapter. Two unique features are the Secure Digital card reader and a PCIe card slot.

If you're an avid gamer looking for a portable gaming solution, this is a godsend.

But if you want to lay your hands on this baby, you'd better start bugging

your cousin in the US, as Dell is not

offering this in India yet.

Priced just short of Rs 1.5 lakh, the XPS Gen 2 is the ultimate gaming laptop available.

Rs 1,50,000

ACER FERRARI 4000

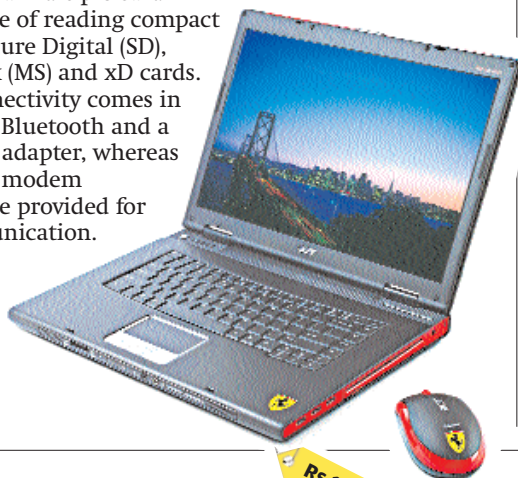
Acer's penchant for speed materialised in the form of their alliance with Scuderia Ferrari as an official partner for laptops. To commemorate this alliance, Acer introduced a series of special-edition Ferrari laptops starting with the Ferrari 3000 series introduced last year. The Ferrari 4000 is the latest in this series, sporting a unique blend of cutting-edge technology and exotic materials.

The 4000 sports a matte-black carbon fibre case with the prominent prancing horse logo shouting for immediate attention. The deep scarlet sides of the laptop make the Ferrari connection come through clearly. Despite being made of lightweight material, the Ferrari 4000 tips the scales at 3 kg, which by today's standards, is a tad too much on the shoulders (or the lap).

Acer doles out 1 GB of DDR 333 MHz memory to make most of your applications zoom by. The 15.4-inch, crisp display is powered by ATI's Mobility Radeon X700 graphics core. To cut down on the thickness, the Ferrari 4000 is provided with a slot loading, multi-format, double-layer DVD burner.

While all common ports such as USB, FireWire, S-Video, VGA and DVI are available, Acer has also included a multiple card reader capable of reading compact flash (CF), Secure Digital (SD), Memory Stick (MS) and xD cards. Wireless connectivity comes in the form of a Bluetooth and a Wi-Fi 802.11g adapter, whereas Ethernet and modem connectors are provided for wired communication.

Priced at around Rs 1 lakh, this is the gadget to have if you're a speed freak.



Rs 1,00,000

LENOVO THINKPAD T42

The ThinkPad T42, a worthy successor to the almost-famous T41 notebook, is the latest in the thin-and-light series from Lenovo. The ThinkPad laptops have always been appreciated by professionals for their rock-solid reliability coupled with good performance, and the T42 doesn't disappoint on either count.

Beating at the heart of the T42 is Intel's Centrino technology, delivering exceptional performance without compromising on battery life. The T42, like all other ThinkPads, has the same understated design, with most surfaces finished in black.

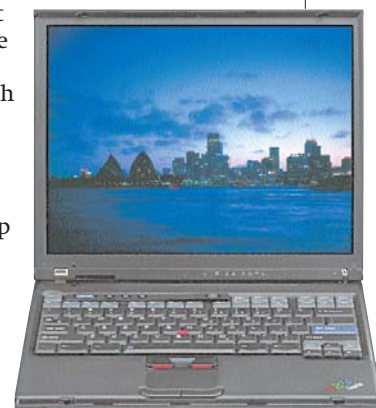
Build quality is top-notch, and it oozes from every nook and corner of the laptop. The metal hinges that clamp the top lid are tough nuts to crack and will take the worst fall without a scratch.

When it comes to the configuration, the T42 isn't spectacular, but has enough horsepower to get most of your work done. It comes with a Pentium M processor running at 1.7 GHz, 512 MB of DDR RAM, a 40 GB hard drive and a combo drive. The upgrades, though available, are unreasonably expensive.

The T42 makes do with just two USB ports, a gigabit Ethernet slot, a modem, two PCMCIA slots, a parallel port, a serial port and a VGA port for connecting an external monitor. Frills such as FireWire or Card readers don't make it to this laptop.

The Lenovo T42 comes preloaded with Windows XP Professional and also boasts of out-of-the-box support for Linux distributions such as RedHat and Suse.

Priced at around Rs 1 lakh, the T42 is our choice for the best executive-class laptop one can buy off-the-shelf.



Rs 1,00,000